

Geography

U.S.





About the Course

Join the Page family as they travel from California to Washington, D.C. While this story is set in the U.S.A., the point of the book is really to explore basic geography concepts such as landforms, water bodies, maps, and regions, so it is suitable for students from any nation. Students use the globe, atlases, and models. Students also make models and draw maps of places important to them such as their neighborhood.



Placement & Combining Tips

This course progresses chronologically over two years. Students who did not take Geography Foundations may wish to incorporate those lessons into the afternoons. This course is intended as a precursor to Grade 3; however, the levels may be reversed in order to combine students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2	Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) 2 times/week 20 min	50 Adventures in the 50 States Cross Country: Geography for Children Making Your Own Maps Redwoods United States Atlas 7th Ed. Student World Atlas 6th Ed.

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)				
Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)		Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

☐ Print the maps needed for some of the future lessons. You will find the map links in the prep section of each lesson.

☐ Print the 5th edition map PDF linked below in the Quick Links section for lessons that use economic symbols (not in the 6th edition of the U.S. atlas).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)



50 Adventures in the 50 States



Cross Country: Geography for Children



Making Your Own Maps



Redwoods



United States Atlas 7th Ed.



Student World Atlas 6th Ed.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)



Globe



Wall World Map



Magnetic Compass



Kinetic Sand



Household Items - Geography: Grade 2



Quick Links

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [5th Edition U.S. Atlas PDF](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 16: Geography\)](#)

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[or scan the QR](#)
[code for links.](#)



Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

How To Teach

	Overview The steps below are generally true for most geography lessons. Sometimes several lessons might build together or focus on a particular area (like Map Work).
	Introduce Through questions, observations, an activity, or recalling the last lesson, introduce the topic for the day.
	Map Questions Answer questions on the map or on making your own maps.
	Read Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently.
	Narrate Have students retell the passage either orally or in writing. They may want to use maps or pictures to tell back.
	Map Work The lesson may contain more map work as students make their own maps or add to ongoing maps.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: US Atlas, Globe, or Wall Map

PREP: Print Blank World Map and Blank North America Map

∞ Map Link: Blank World Map

∞ Map Link: Blank North America Map

→ INTRO

In geography this year, we will journey across the USA. Geography is learning about different places around the world. All kinds of maps are used to help us in the study of geography—globes, wall maps, and atlases.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

1. Find the United States of America.
2. Find the equator. Is the United States north or south of the equator?
3. What is to the west of the United States? (Pacific Ocean) To the east? (Atlantic Ocean) To the north? (Canada) To the south? (Mexico and the Gulf of Mexico)

→ MAP WORK

Add the Blank World Map (referred to moving forward as "My World Map") and the Blank North America Map (referred to moving forward as "My North America Map") to your geography journal.

Map Resource: My World Map

1. Add the title "My World Map."
2. Color in the United States of America.

Map Resource: My North America Map

1. Add title "My North America Map."
2. Label the borders of the contiguous United States. (Pacific Ocean, Atlantic Ocean, Gulf of Mexico, Canada, Mexico)

→ READ & NARRATE

United States Atlas

p.14 "Like a giant" - "single circle."

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: US Atlas "The Political United States", p.14-15

1. Locate California, and specifically Los Angeles, California, on the West Coast.
2. Locate Maryland and Washington, D.C. on the East Coast.

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My North America Map

1. Add Los Angeles (with a dot) and Washington, D.C. (with a star inside a circle) to the map and label each.
2. Label the United States in the Northern Area of the USA.

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Near the beginning of term 2, we will have some lessons about how water moves. Depending on where you live, it may rain often or not much at all. Please start to take notes on where the water goes when it rains. Look for where it goes near your home, and even see if you can follow it in your neighborhood. The notes can go in your nature or geography journal.

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

Meet the Pages

Materials: Cross-Country, Blank U.S. Map, Geography journal

PREP: Print Blank U.S. Map (referred to moving forward as "My U.S. Map")

∞ Map Link: Blank U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Let's look at the map in the front of the Cross-Country book. What do you notice?

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→ MAP QUESTIONS

📖 Map Resource: Inside Cover Cross-Country

Locate the red line. This book is about a family that travels along that line (route) across the United States.

1. Locate your state. Does the trip go through your state? If not, how many states away from the red line do you live?
2. Locate Los Angeles and place your finger on it. Trace your finger from there all the way across the United States to Washington, D.C.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.6-7 "The man" - "it will rain!"

→ MAP WORK

1. Add the Blank US Map to your geography journal.
2. Add the title "My US Map" (making sure the title does not cover any states).
3. Add Los Angeles and Washington, D.C.
4. Label California.

WEEK 2 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

Compass

📖 Materials: compass, paper, tape

→ DISCUSS

There are naturally occurring magnetic rocks called magnetite, but modern compasses use a magnetized needle. Both magnetite and a modern magnetic needle, when allowed to move freely, will swing to point north. Today, we will use a compass to find direction in your classroom or room in your home.

→ DEMONSTRATE

1. Place the compass in the middle of the room and allow it to stop moving.
2. The needle will be pointing north. You must move the N sign on the compass to line up with the point of the needle.
3. On a piece of paper, write N for north and tape it to the wall that the compass is pointing to.
4. When you face north, east will be on your right, west on your left, and south directly behind you.
5. Using these directions, make more sheets with E, W, and S on them and tape them to your walls.

→ PLAY

Using the directions on the walls, take turns with another student or teacher, following directions such as "take 3 steps east" or "take 2 giant steps south." You can even make it into a Mother May I game.

WEEK 2 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

Compass Rose

📖 Materials: compass, chalk

→ DISCUSS

During the last lesson, we found direction inside, and today we will find direction outside and create a compass rose.

→ DEMONSTRATE

1. Draw a large circle on a paved area. Place the compass in the middle and allow it to stop moving.
2. The needle will be pointing north. You must move the N sign on the

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compass to line up with the point of the needle.

3. Draw a line from the N side of the compass straight to the edge of the circle, and mark it with an N.

4. Do the same thing with E, W, and S.

5. Today, we will add more directions to the compass rose. Halfway between the N and the E, you will write a NE, which stands for Northeast, on the circle. Halfway between N and W, you will write NW, which stands for Northwest. Continue by adding a SE between S and E, for southeast, and add SW between S and W, for southwest.

6. You will notice that it is easier to give more accurate directions because you have more to refer to.

→ PLAY

1. Using the directions on the compass rose, take turns with another student or teacher, following directions such as "take 3 steps northeast" or "take 2 giant steps southwest." This can be played like Mother May I.
2. Another game you can play is to give directions to an object, like a tree, outside by saying things like "take 5 steps west, and then 2 steps northwest. What is there?"

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

Compass Rose and Map Key

 Materials: Making Your Own Maps

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.4-7 "You've moved" - "these tools!"

→ MAP QUESTION

 Map Resource: Making Your Own Maps, various pages

1. Can you find the compass rose on p.7? Which directions are on it?
2. Locate the keys on p.5 and 7. What symbols do they use? How are they the same or different?
3. Look at keys on maps on p.15,16,19, and 21. How are they the same or different?

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

Airport

 Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.8-9 "One night" - "ask for it!"

→ MAP QUESTION

 Map Resource: United States Atlas, "The Political United States: Population" p.16-17

1. Locate the map keys (there are 2), as well as Los Angeles, CA, and Washington, D.C.
2. What do the colors mean on the rightmost map key? How do the color symbols change with the numbers? (Larger numbers are represented by darker colors.)
3. What do the symbols mean in the other map key? How do they change with the number ranges? (The symbols get larger as the population increases.)
4. What do you notice about the areas near Los Angeles and Washington, D.C.?
5. Find your home state and general location. How does your area's population compare with Los Angeles or Washington, D.C.?

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→ MAP WORK

□ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. Add your city (or closest town) to your map, and label it.

WEEK 4 □ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 7

Over Los Angeles

□ Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

Have you ever flown on a plane? Could you see out the window? What did it look like?

→ MAP QUESTION

□ Map Resource: Illustrations on p.10, 11, and 12 of Cross-Country

1. Look at p.10 and p.11. What do you notice on each one? (Do you see streets, cars, houses, and large buildings?)
2. Which picture is taken further up in the air? (p.11) How can you tell? (buildings look smaller)
3. What are the "wrinkly" bits? (mountains) Can you see any other natural things? (possibly a river, fields)
4. I wonder why the city stops where it does? (possibly the mountains)
5. Turn to p.12. What is different about this illustration? (It is mainly water.) What can you see? (boats, ports, roads, buildings)
6. Is the illustration on p.12 closer or farther away than the previous illustrations? How can you tell?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10-12 "It was a little" - "see the people."

WEEK 4 □ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

Types of Maps Intro

→ INTRO

We are going to spend a few lessons learning about different types of maps.

→ DISCUSS

1. Today, we will look at the first 2 types of maps. The first we will call a model or 3-dimensional map. Last year, you used blocks (or some other objects) to make maps. You did this with your room, your home, your neighbors, etc.
2. The second type of map we will call a pictorial view. It is a drawing of a street-level view of a home, building, etc. You also drew these last year when you drew your home and neighboring homes/buildings.

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the linked map pictures.

1. Look at the linked Room Model and Model Showing Orientation.
∞ Image link: Room Model
∞ Image link: Model Showing Orientation
2. Make a quick model of a room in your home or school.
3. Look at the linked pictorial view of a house. It will be at eye level, and drawn as if you are looking directly at it.
∞ Image link: Pictorial map
4. If time permits, draw a pictorial view of your home from the outside.

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WEEK 5 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Types of Maps, Continued

Materials: Making Your Own Maps

→ RECAP

What types of maps did we discuss in the last lesson?

→ DISCUSS

1. Today, we will look at the next 2 types of maps. The first we will call a panoramic 3D map. Imagine you are a bird high up in a tree looking down at your home; what kind of drawing would that make? How would it look different from the street view of your home?

2. The second type of map we will call an aerial view. This time, imagine you are a bird flying directly over your home; what kind of drawing would that make? (could only see the roof) How is this different than the panoramic view?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the linked map pictures as well as one in Making Your Own Maps.

1. Look at the linked Panoramic 3D map, and have the student identify its type.

∞ Map Link: Panoramic 3D map

2. Look at the linked Aerial View map, and have the student identify its type.

∞ Map Link: Aerial View map

3. Look at Making Your Own Maps p.16. What type of map is this, based on what we studied today? (panoramic)

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Near the beginning of term 2, we will have some lessons about how water moves. Don't forget to keep an eye out when it rains. Try to pay attention to a light rain versus a hard rain. Don't forget to keep notes in your geography or nature journal.

WEEK 5 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 10

Types of Maps, Continued

Materials: Making Your Own Maps

→ RECAP

What types of maps did we discuss in the last lesson?

→ DISCUSS

Today, we will look at the last type of map we will be discussing this year. This type of map is a symbolic map. These can vary greatly. Making Your Own Maps is full of symbolic maps. As you read today, look for maps that are not models, pictorial, panoramic, or aerial.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-15 "Say you" - "stands for."

→ DISCUSS

Did you find symbol maps? (p.5, 7, 8, 11, 13, 15) Note: If there is confusion about why some of those are not pictorial or panoramic, look back at the previous 2 lessons.

WEEK 6 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 11

The Pages Are Moving

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Do you know what kinds of plants grow near your home?

→ MAP QUESTION

Map Resource: United States Atlas, "The Political United States: Political Map" p.14-15

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Go for a walk in your neighborhood. What grows near you? What type of vegetation (trees, bushes, flowers, etc.) grows near you?

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1. Locate Los Angeles, CA, and Denver, CO.
 2. Remember the approximate locations of these cities, as you will mark them lightly on the next map.
- 📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" p.8-9
1. Mark lightly the approximate locations of Los Angeles and Denver.
 2. Find the map key; what do the colors mean? (vegetation/biome)
 3. What do you notice about the areas around Los Angeles and Denver? Are they the same or different?
 4. Find your home state and general location. What is the vegetation near you? Compare it to those near Los Angeles and Denver.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.13 "It was big" - "buy this place."

→ MAP WORK

- 📄 Map Resource: My US Map
1. Add Denver, CO
 2. Add anything else of interest. (Could add a small illustration of what grows in each place.)

WEEK 6 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 12

Compass Rose and Directions

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

We have talked about directions in your room/classroom and outdoors. Today, we will learn about directions on a map.

→ MAP QUESTION

- ∞ Map Link: Map of the US with a compass rose
1. Find the compass rose on the linked map of the US.
 2. What direction is north? south? east? west?
 3. Based on those directions, add a compass rose to the map in the front of Cross-Country. (You can draw directly on the page or use a small sticky note.)
 4. Using the map in Cross-Country, what is to the west of Los Angeles? (Pacific Ocean)
 5. What ocean is east of Washington, D.C.? (Atlantic Ocean)
 6. If we travel from Los Angeles to Washington, D.C., which direction would you travel? (east)
 7. Where do you live? Which direction would you go to get to Washington, D.C.?

→ MAP WORK

Add a compass rose to your map.

WEEK 7 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 13

Islands

📄 Materials: World Wall Map or Globe

→ MAP QUESTION

1. Locate your home on the globe.
2. Locate the Equator. Do you live north or south of it?
3. Which continent do you live on?
4. Which ocean is closest to you?
5. What is an island? (A body of land surrounded by water.)
6. Locate a very large island in the Atlantic Ocean. (The largest island is Greenland, which extends from the Arctic Ocean into the North Atlantic Ocean. Other islands are listed in the next question.)

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7. Can you locate any more islands in the Atlantic Ocean? (Possibilities include Iceland, Ireland, Great Britain, Newfoundland, and the Falklands, among others.)
8. Some islands in the Pacific Ocean are isolated, while others exist in groups. Can you locate a group of islands in the Pacific Ocean? (Aleutian Islands, Hawaii, Galápagos Islands, Japan, Philippine Islands, Northern Mariana Islands, Marshall Islands, Micronesia, Solomon Islands, Cook Islands, French Polynesia, and New Zealand, among many others.)
9. Can you locate standalone islands in the Pacific that are not part of a group? (This question is more of a scavenger hunt, and the student may only name Vancouver Island and Taiwan. Searching for individual islands in the Pacific Ocean makes it apparent that almost all islands in this ocean are part of a larger group.)
10. What is an island close to you?
11. Do you see any islands close to Los Angeles?

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 14

Catalina Island

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas

→ INTRO

Charlotte Mason defined an island as follows in her book, *Elementary Geography*. "The high parts of the ocean bed rise above water in many places in the Pacific. These are called islands. An island is just a piece of land with water all around it. On the map, you will find many islands scattered over the Pacific Ocean. They are mostly small and lie in groups; that is, several clustered together."

→ MAP QUESTION

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The West: Political Map" p.129 and "California" p.135

1. Locate Los Angeles on the first map, and then on the 2nd map. Use the California map for the rest of the questions.
2. Locate islands off the southern California Coast. (Channel Islands)
3. Within those, locate Santa Catalina Island.
4. From Los Angeles, which direction do you travel to get to Catalina Island? (southwest)
5. How could you travel to Catalina from Los Angeles? (boat or plane)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.14-15 "The next morning" - "plane over the water."

WEEK 8 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 15

Catalina Island, Continued

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, 50 Adventures in the 50 States, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Have you ever been to an island? If you lived on an island, what are some things you could do for fun? Let's see what Tom and Ruth do at Catalina Island.

→ MAP QUESTION

Map Resource: United States Atlas "California" p.135

1. Locate (Santa) Catalina Island.
2. Do you see other islands near Catalina? Name some. (Santa Rosa, Santa Cruz, and San Clemente.)
3. There is a name for this archipelago (group of islands). Can you find it? (Channel Islands)
4. What ocean are they located in? (Pacific Ocean)

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country p.15-16 "After the plane" - "I'm playing island!"

→ MAP WORK

🗺 Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Add and label Catalina Island.

→ READ

50 Adventures in the 50 States
p.14-15 Venice Beach is right next to Los Angeles. Look at the page spread and read about surfing there.

WEEK 8 🗓 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 16

Redwoods

🗺 Materials: Redwoods, United States Atlas

→ INTRO

We are going to spend some time exploring a different part of the California coast.

→ MAP QUESTION

🗺 Map Resource: United States Atlas "California" p.135

1. Locate the key. Find the symbols for National Park Service Units, National Forests, National Wildlife Refuges, and National Marine Sanctuaries.
2. Some of the Channel Islands are part of a National Park. Locate and name the park. (Santa Rosa and Santa Cruz islands are part of Channel Islands National Park.)
3. Traveling along the coast, see how many parks, forests, and refuges you can find.
4. Locate Redwood National Park in the northern end of California.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Redwoods
p.1-11 (The book is not numbered, so p.1 is considered the page with only the boy sitting on the bench noticing the book.)
"The coast redwoods" - "two feet per year."

WEEK 9 🗓 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 17

Redwoods

🗺 Materials: Redwoods, United States Atlas

→ MAP QUESTION

🗺 Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Climate" p.10-11

1. Locate California. (Check p.14 if you are not sure where it is.)
2. Remember that Redwood National Forest is on the coast in very Northern California. What is the climate there? Look at the key. (marine west coast)
3. What do you think that means for the Redwood Forest? (a lot of rain)
4. Locate your state and the general area where you live. How does your climate compare to that in Northern California?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Redwoods
p.12-22 "Redwoods also" - "endangered species."

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WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 18

Redwoods

Materials: Redwoods, United States Atlas

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" p.8-9

1. Locate California. (Check p.14 if you are not sure where it is.)
2. Remember that Redwood National Forest is on the coast in very Northern California. What does the key tell us about the vegetation there? (needleleaf forest)
3. What type of tree is a Redwood? Hint: What type of leaves does it have? (needleleaf)
4. Locate your state and the general area where you live. How does your natural vegetation compare to that in Northern California?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Redwoods

p.23-end "When a redwood" - "fit right in."

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 19

Maps

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "How to Use This Atlas" p.7

1. What do the symbols for cities look like? (Dots/circles)
2. Why are the dots different sizes? (Population of the city)
3. What symbol represents a state capital? (Circled star) National capital? (Star inside double circle.)

Map Resource: "Your State" (United States Atlas state pages)

1. Locate your hometown.
2. Is your town or city (or closest municipality) labeled? Why or why not?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.17-18 "It was the day" - "stands for Los Angeles."

• GEOGRAPHY WORK

Get a map of your city or local jurisdiction and explore it, looking for familiar places. Paper maps may be available from the local Planning Department or Chamber of Commerce.

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 20

Map Symbols

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas

→ INTRO

Last time, Tom found his city—Los Angeles. This week, he will learn a little more about the map.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.18-20 "'Now', said Father" - "as it can be!"

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Political United States" p.14-15

1. Locate Washington, D.C.
2. Locate Los Angeles.
3. Look across the United States and locate the state of Maryland.
4. Locate Washington, D.C. What symbol represents it? (Double circle with large star inside.)

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5. Locate Washington, D.C., on the inside front cover map of Cross-Country.
6. Do you know what that symbol means? (Country's capital)

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 21

Map Work

Materials: Globe or World Wall Map

→ DISCUSS

1. In the last reading, did you notice why Ruth responded to Tom's question the way she did?
2. Notice that Mr. Page explained to Tom that blue "stands for" oceans, lakes, and rivers.
3. How does Tom try to explain the way cities and water are represented on the map?
4. Why do maps use symbols? Why is it important to know what those symbols represent?
5. We are going to spend time looking at the land and the "blue" areas today.

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: globe or world wall map

1. Locate the Equator.
2. Where is the Northern Hemisphere? Southern Hemisphere?
3. Where is the North Pole? South Pole?
4. We are going to locate the 7 continents. Locate North America, South America, Europe, Asia, Australia, Africa, and Antarctica.
5. We are going to locate the 4 (or 5) named oceans of the world. Locate the Atlantic Ocean.
6. Locate the Pacific Ocean.
7. Locate the Indian Ocean.
8. Locate the Arctic Ocean.
9. Locate the Southern Ocean. (National Geographic atlases do not recognize the Southern Ocean as its own distinct ocean.)
10. Some people divide the Pacific and Atlantic Oceans into northern and southern parts. Where is the North Atlantic Ocean? South Atlantic Ocean? North Pacific Ocean? South Pacific Ocean?
11. Which ocean is the northernmost? (Arctic) The southernmost? (Southern)
12. Which continent is the largest? (Asia) The smallest? (Australia)
13. Which ocean is the largest? (Pacific) The smallest? (Arctic)
14. Locate the Atlantic Ocean. It is bounded on the east by which continent(s)? (Europe and Africa.)
15. The Atlantic Ocean is bounded on the west by which continent(s)? (North and South America.)
16. Locate the Pacific Ocean. Which continent(s) borders the Pacific Ocean on the east? (North and South America.) On the west? (Asia and Australia.)
17. Locate the Indian Ocean. Which continent(s) border the Indian Ocean on the east? (Asia and Australia.) On the west? (Africa) On the north? (Asia)
18. Locate the Arctic Ocean, and identify which continent(s) it borders. (North America, Europe, and Asia.)
19. Locate the area of water known as the Southern Ocean, and identify which continent(s) it borders. (Antarctica. Some maps from Australia consider the Southern Ocean extending as far north as its southern coast.)

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Near the beginning of term 2, we will have some lessons about how water moves. Try to pay attention to where water stays after the rain; where it pools. Don't forget to keep notes in your geography or nature journal.

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Term 1

WEEK 11 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 22

Globe

☐ Materials: Cross-Country, globe

→ INTRO

Today, we will go over some information that you may already know, but enjoy it as a review if you do.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

☐ Map Resource: globe

1. Imagine a ball for the first few questions.
2. Does a ball have a top and a bottom? (Yes, but you can easily turn it to change what is "top" and "bottom")
3. Does it have an end? (No.)
4. Are you able to see all of the ball at one time? (No, because you can only see the part facing you.)
5. Is there any way to see all of it at once? (No. If you turn it in any direction, there is still a part you can't see.)
6. Now look at the globe. How does the globe compare to a ball? How are they the same? Different?
7. Are you able to see all parts of the globe at once?
8. What do you already know about a globe?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-24 "Can you think" - "center of the earth."

WEEK 12 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Cross-Country

WEEK 12 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Redwoods



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 25

Materials: Map of Your Street

PREP: Map: Google Maps (Street View), Google Earth, Bing Maps (Streetside), a map application, or some other image that will allow an eye-level view of your home. This will be used during this lesson and the next.

→ INTRO

Could you see your street on the maps in the last lesson? (No, the maps have a large scale.) Today we will be able to see your street and even your home.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: “Your street and house” (Use a phone or computer to view a street-level image.)

1. Find your home. (This is a good time to learn your home address.)
2. Can you see your neighbor’s home? Your street?
3. Zoom out. What happens to the image? What changes? Can you see your home?
4. Zoom out enough for it to look similar to your state map in the United States Atlas.
5. Zoom bit by bit all the way back in. What happens?
6. Why do you think your house/street is not on the atlas map?

→ NOTE

Next week, you will need a printed copy of the street view of this in order to do the pet map of the neighborhood.

You can also use time in the afternoons this week, interviewing neighbors about their pets (what types and how many) to be added to a map next week.

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 26

Pet Map

Materials: Google Map (Street View)

PREP: Print the Google Maps (Street View), Google Earth, Bing Maps (Streetside), a map application, or some other image that will allow a view of your immediate neighborhood. If you live in an apartment building, it might be easier to print a photo of the front of the building and note which apartments are which.

→ INTRO

It would be fun to see what pets live in your neighborhood, and to add them to your Google Map you explored last week. If you have not already, interview neighbors about what types of pets they have and how many.

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Google Map of the neighborhood

1. Create a key showing symbols for each type of pet.
2. Add the symbols to the neighbors’ houses/apartments on your map.
3. If there is more than 1 pet per residence, add multiple symbols to each residence.
4. If you would like, share your map with a family member or friend and tell them what you learned about your neighbors.

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Term 2

WEEK 2 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

Latitude and Longitude

Materials: Globe

→ INTRO

We are going to spend some time today learning more about the lines on your globe.

→ MAP WORK

• Latitude

1. Locate the Equator, Tropic of Capricorn, and Tropic of Cancer.
2. Locate 2 more named lines of latitude. (Arctic Circle and Antarctic Circle)
3. Is the Arctic Circle located in the Northern or Southern Hemisphere? (Northern)
4. Which other major circle of latitude is located in the Northern Hemisphere? (Tropic of Cancer)
5. Which 2 major circles of latitude are located in the Southern Hemisphere? (Antarctic Circle and Tropic of Capricorn.)
6. Name the continents that touch the Arctic Circle. (North America, Europe, and Asia.) The Antarctic Circle? (Antarctica)

• Longitude

1. Locate the prime meridian. (look in England)
2. Name a line of longitude that goes through both North and South America. (Roughly between 35°W and 81°W.)
3. Name a line of longitude that goes through both Asia and Australia. (Roughly between 114°E and 153°E.)
4. Name a line of longitude that goes through both Europe and Africa. (Roughly between 17°W and 52°E.)
5. Can you locate a line of longitude that passes through Antarctica but no other continents? (No)

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Next week, we will have our lessons on how water moves. Make sure you have your notes ready from previous rain walks.

WEEK 2 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

Map Projections

Materials: Globe, World Map

→ INTRO

We are going to compare your globe to your wall map of the world.

→ MAP WORK

1. Locate the 7 continents on your globe, and then on the wall map.
2. Compare the sizes of each continent on the globe. Now compare the sizes of each continent on the wall map. Are there any differences in the relative sizes depicted on the globe versus the sizes depicted on the wall map? (For example, Africa is the 2nd largest continent on the globe. However, North America appears to be the 2nd largest continent on the wall map.)
3. What do you notice about the differences of Antarctica? (Antarctica appears stretched on the wall map.)
4. Are there any differences in the sizes of the oceans? (The Arctic and Southern Oceans appear larger on the wall map than their depiction on the globe.)
5. Practical question: If you wanted to peel an orange and lay the peel flat, how could you do that? What would it look like?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

1. Watch the following Map Projections video on YouTube.
∞ Video Link: Map Projections video
2. Using your globe and wall map, spend the rest of your time comparing

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continents and countries on each. What are the biggest differences?
3. Which projection is your wall map? (Reference the fine print on the map.)

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 29

Water Moves

PREP: This is the lesson where you will use information you have gathered while noticing what happens around your home during rain.

→ INTRO

We have found some of the large bodies of water on our globe, oceans. We will locate other bodies of water later, but let's just focus on water today, and how it moves. Have you been paying attention to where water goes when it rains near your home?

→ DISCUSS

1. What do you notice when it rains? Is there a difference when it rains lightly versus heavily? Is there a difference when it is a quick shower versus rain that lasts many hours or even days?
2. When the rain falls on the roof of your home, where does it go? (Gutters, straight off the sides, etc.)
3. Is there any place near your home where you know you will find a puddle after the rain?
4. Why do you think water stays in that spot? Is it a big area? (You should notice high and low places and that water runs to low places.)
5. Is there anything else you have noticed about how water moves near your home?
6. Do you water plants at your home? What happens when you water them? Is there a difference in watering a plant in a pot versus in the ground? How often do you have to water plants/grass outside where you live?

→ DRAW

1. On a piece of blank paper, the teacher can draw a general outline of the school/home from above.
2. Have the student draw some of the places that water moves around the home/school, noting places where the water puddles. These are the low places.

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 30

Geography Model

Materials: something large and flat; either a cookie sheet or cutting board, kinetic sand or clay, sink, water source

→ INTRO

Today, we will watch water move on a small scale.

→ DEMONSTRATE

1. Tilt the flat surface into the sink so that the outside end is 1 inch higher than the end in the sink.
2. Pour water slowly onto the raised end and note what it does.
3. Raise the outside end to about 3 inches, and then 6 inches, pouring water slowly both times at the same spot. Do you notice any differences? (water moves faster the higher it starts)
4. Lay the surface flat, dry it, and build a few mountains in the center of it, making a place for a "river" to run.
5. Re-do steps 1 through 3 and make notes on what you see. Does the water adjust its course as it reaches the mountains? Does it follow the course you thought it would?

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WEEK 4 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 31

Rain Gauge

☐ Materials: empty jar with a wide opening, plastic ruler, masking tape, and pen or Sharpie

→ INTRO

Today, we will make a simple rain gauge.

→ DEMONSTRATE

1. Set up your jar or can outside to collect rainwater.
2. Place a ruler inside the jar and tape it on the outside.
3. Use the ruler to mark 1/4 inch, 1/2 inch, 3/4 inch, and 1 inch. Continue by quarter inches up to 2 inches.
4. You will check the rain jar daily to see how much it has rained. Make notes on a page in your geography journal about how much it rains (when it rains). Don't forget to empty the jar after you make note of the amount, so that you start again from zero.
5. At the end of each week and month, add up how much it has rained in total.

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the US Precipitation Map to see how much it rains near Los Angeles, California. Also, look at your area on the map. Are they similar or different?

∞ Image Link: US Precipitation Map

WEEK 4 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 32

An Orange Grove and Water

☐ Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Today, the Pages are going to leave for Washington, D.C. I wonder how far they will get!

→ MAP QUESTIONS

☐ Map Resource: Inside front cover of Cross-Country and United States Atlas, "California" p.135

1. Locate Los Angeles on the inside front cover map of Cross-Country.
2. Today, the Pages don't travel very far at all. They will follow the red line only a short way—about an hour. (If necessary, point out that the family is not actually following a real line painted on the road.)
3. Locate Los Angeles in the United States Atlas.
4. Do you think they will still be in California?
5. Parents must do this: use the scale in the United States Atlas to show about how far 25 miles is from Los Angeles. This will show clearly that they are still very close to Los Angeles.
6. Do you remember the type of fruit trees that grew in the Pages' yard in Los Angeles? (Lemons and oranges.)
7. Do you think the same fruit will grow here that grew in their yard?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.26-27 "An hour after" - "orange juice."

→ DISCUSS

Geography is the study of place. Based on what we just learned from the visit with Mr. Green, how have California orange farmers learned to alter their environment/place in order to grow their crops?

→ MAP WORK

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📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Add a drawing of an orange or orange tree immediately east of Los Angeles.

WEEK 5 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 33

Water Cycle

PREP: Watch the NSF Water Cycle video as teacher prep. It does a good job explaining terminology, but is very fact-driven, so you may want to use the linked water cycle image for your student to look at as you explain.

∞ Video Link: NSF Water Cycle video

∞ Image Link: Water Cycle image

→ DRAW

Do a drawing of the water cycle together, making sure the main points of evaporation and condensation, along with precipitation, runoff/collection, etc., are covered. Water is always moving.

WEEK 5 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

Water Cycle Model

PREP: Watch both videos in order to see which one would be best for your student. Gather supplies according to the choice you make.

The plastic bag version uses gallon bag, marker, water, blue water color, tape.

The bowl version uses boiling water, plastic wrap, water, clear large and small bowls.

∞ Video Link: Water Cycle in a Plastic Bag

∞ Video Link: Water Cycle in a Bowl

→ MODEL

1. Today, we will make a model to show some of the water cycle.
2. Either watch the chosen video and stop as it goes so that your student can observe first-hand what happens, OR explain to the student the steps that were taken in the video.
3. Orally narrate or draw a picture of what happened.

WEEK 6 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

The Desert

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. Locate Los Angeles.
2. What is west of Los Angeles? (Pacific Ocean) What do you think that crinkly area is to the east of Los Angeles? (Mountains)
Today, in our reading, the Pages will travel past those mountains and head east. What do you guess it will be like on the other side of the mountains?

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" p.8–9

1. Locate Los Angeles (may need to look at p.14 to find the location), and using the map key, tell what the color around Los Angeles is. What does that color represent? (Grassland and a little bit of forest)
2. Now, go east—past the mountains. What is the color? (Tan/light orange)
3. Using the map key, what does this color represent? (Arid/semi-arid, which means having little or no rain.)
4. Now, what do you guess it will be like on the other side of the mountains? (Very dry)
5. What do you think will grow there?

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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.28 "Good as" - "shade of an orange tree."

→ MAP WORK

▢ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. Add a drawing, like a cactus or shining sun, to represent the desert past the mountains.

WEEK 6 ▢ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 36

Geography Model

▢ Materials: Cross-Country, Moon Sand (Kinetic Sand)

→ DISCUSS

1. Use your own words to describe how a desert might look, feel, and sound.
2. Look at the picture on p.28 (Cross-Country). Compare the picture to what you imagined. (You should gain a general understanding that deserts are hot, dry, and barren. It does rain in the desert, but very little. Plants like the cactus must store water in their stems to survive.)

→ MODEL

Now you are going to make a model of a desert. The student needs to help decide what should be included.

WEEK 7 ▢ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 37

The Desert, Continued

▢ Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

Were your predictions about the area past the mountains correct last time?

We are going to learn a little more about the desert past the mountains. What do you think the Pages will see in the desert?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-29 "If you are a little older" - "You go to sleep."

→ VIEW

Look at photos of a California desert during the short rainy season.
∞ Image Link: Superbloom in California Desert

WEEK 7 ▢ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 38

The Desert, Continued

▢ Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in the 50 States

→ INTRO

I wonder what Ruth and Tom will wake up to?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

▢ Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Climate" p.10–11

1. Locate the area of California east of Los Angeles.
2. Based on the map key, what climate zones are east of Los Angeles? (Semiarid and arid)
3. You already know this area is a desert. What do you think lives there? Do you think people would live in a desert?

▢ Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Political United States: Population" p.16–17

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1. Locate the area of California east of Los Angeles.
2. Based on the map key, where is the population highest—Los Angeles or the desert? (Los Angeles)

3. Were your predictions correct about the population based on this map?
□ Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Political United States: Political Map" p.14–15

1. Locate the area of California east of Los Angeles.
2. What are the two states east of California? (Nevada, Arizona)
3. East of Los Angeles, in eastern California and into Nevada, is a desert. What is its name? (Mojave Desert)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.30-31 "Arf, arf!" - "had been looking for- Silver."

→ MAP WORK

□ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. Add Mojave Desert.
2. Label Nevada.

→ VIEW

50 Adventures in the 50 States

p.60-61 Look at the page spread and read about what it is like in the desert in Nevada at night.

WEEK 8 □ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 39

Silver

□ Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas

→ INTRO

Why do you think Silver and his owner live in the desert?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: United States Atlas "Nevada" p.145 (See 5th Ed. PDF if you have a newer edition)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Find the symbol for mining on the map key. (note: it can stand for gold, silver, etc.)
2. Can you find the mining symbol anywhere in Nevada?
3. Does it make sense that the man named his dog Silver?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.31-32 "Why do you and Silver" - "both of you!"

→ MAP WORK

□ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Add a symbol for mining to Nevada (if you have space available).

∞ GATHER SUPPLIES

small amount of sand, a piece of glitter

• GEOGRAPHY WORK

Practice your mining skills by putting a few pieces of glitter into a couple cups of sand. Look for the glitter. I wonder what it would be like to look through a larger amount of sand.

WEEK 8 □ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 40

Linear Map

□ Materials: Geography journal

→ INTRO

Last year, you made a map of your room or schoolroom. Today, we will start a map of a hall or a linear area of your home or school.

→ MAP DRAWING

1. Choose an area to map that is in a line (referred to as linear). For example, a hall.
2. Begin to draw your linear space in your Geography journal.

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3. Make sure to represent anything in the hall that takes up space on the floor. (any tables, bookshelves, carpet, etc.)
4. Next lesson, we will add any doors that connect to the hall (or other linear space). This will take 2 lessons, so we will finish it next week.

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 41

Linear Map

 Materials: Geography journal

→ MAP DRAWING

1. We are going to continue your “Linear map” in your geography journal.
2. Now, we will add any doors that connect to the hall (or other linear space).
3. Make sure to look back at the real space as you draw in order to keep things in order.
4. When you are done, feel free to color your map, if desired.

→ NOTE

If the student really enjoys this, feel free to do other spaces that they are familiar with, such as a hall at a friend’s or family member’s house. It might be a fun challenge to see what they remember about a familiar house, and then to go see it and map it. Did they remember the correct order of rooms off the hall?

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 42

Linear Street Map

 Materials: wooden blocks, Duplos or Legos attached to each other, or small boxes (like the size of single-serving cereal boxes), paper, pencil, or colored pencils

→ NOTE

This map project will take 4 lessons. The focus again is to keep things in a linear order.

→ INTRO

We are going to make another type of “linear” map. This time, we will be using blocks with pictures taped on them to make a 3-dimensional map.

→ MAP DRAWING

1. Choose an area that you can see from your home/school, or very close to it. (It can be the street where you live, or possibly a small strip of stores.)
2. Last year, you may have made a map of your house and a couple of neighbors. This year, you will draw more. Decide if you want to make a map of just one side of the street or both sides.
3. Spend several minutes really looking at the area you chose. Ask questions like...How many buildings are there? Are the buildings all the same size? If not, which ones are bigger? And how much bigger?
4. Pay attention to the order the buildings are in.
5. Draw a simple picture of each home/building and tape it to a block.

→ NOTE

Next week, the student will finish drawing the homes/buildings.

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WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 43

Linear Street Map, Continued

Materials: wooden blocks, Duplos or Legos attached to each other, or small boxes (like the size of single-serving cereal boxes), paper, pencil, or colored pencils

→ MAP DRAWING

(Street View Map)

1. Finish drawing the pictures of homes/buildings and taping to the blocks.
2. Teacher and student work together to set up the blocks/boxes to match the street.

→ NOTE

Next lesson, you will begin drawing a map of your “street.”

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 44

Linear Street Map, Continued

Materials: blocks with pictures from the previous lesson, geography journal, pencil, or colored pencils

→ MAP DRAWING

(Street View Map)

1. Set up your street view with the blocks again.
2. Draw in your geography journal a simple map of your street (blocks). (Note: You can choose to draw only one side of the street or both sides.)
3. Pay attention as you draw your map. Does it match the blocks? Are they in the right order?

→ NOTE

The drawing of the Street View Map will continue next lesson. Also, we will move the blocks and set them up again, just using the map from your geography journal.

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 45

Linear Street Map, Conclusion

Materials: blocks with pictures from the previous lesson, a pencil or colored pencils, Geography journal

→ MAP DRAWING

(Street View Map)

1. Finish drawing into your geography journal a simple map of your street (blocks). (Note: You can choose to draw only one side of the street or both sides.)
2. Pay attention as you draw your map. Does it match the blocks? Are they in the right order?
3. Now, move the blocks and mix them up.
4. Only using the Street View Map that you made in your geography journal, set up the blocks in the correct order again.
5. If time allows, go outside and see if your drawn Street View Map matches the “real thing.”

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 46

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

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WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Cross-Country

WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Models and maps made during the term

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Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 49

Hoover Dam

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

I wonder how long the Pages were in the desert!

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The West: Physical Map" p.128 and "Nevada" p.145

1. Locate the Mojave Desert.
2. The Mojave Desert is primarily located in which two (2) states? (California and Nevada)
3. Name the lake east of the Mojave Desert. (Lake Mead)
4. Can you name the river that Lake Mead is on? (Colorado River)
5. The Colorado River is part of the border of Nevada. It separates Nevada from what other state? (Arizona)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.33 "A drink was" - "going to see tomorrow."

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Arizona.

→ OBSERVE

If time permits, recreate what Ruth and her father saw in the tub. You can use a tub or sink.

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 50

Hoover Dam, Continued

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "Nevada" p.145

1. Locate the Colorado River in southernmost Nevada.
2. Locate Lake Mead.
3. There is a large dam at Lake Mead. Locate and name the dam. (Hoover Dam)

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States" p.8-9

1. Locate the Colorado River in the western United States. Find where it begins in Colorado.
2. Run your finger along the entire Colorado River. You are not able to see the entire thing because it flows into Mexico.
3. Teacher: Help the student locate Lake Mead on the map by comparing it to the map of Nevada.

Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. Can you find the beginning (headwaters/source) of the Colorado River on this map?
2. Follow the river to Lake Mead. Do you see the Hoover Dam?
3. If you continue to follow the Colorado River, where does it go? (Through Mexico, emptying into the Gulf of California.)
4. The Colorado River has gone from the Rocky Mountains in Colorado all the way to the ocean!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.34 "The next day" - "end of the bathtub!"

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→ MAP WORK

- ☐ Map Resource: My U.S. Map
1. Add and label Lake Mead.
 2. Add and label the Colorado River.

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 51

Lake Mead and Great Salt Lake

☐ Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in the 50 States

→ INTRO

Have you ever been to a lake? What did you do there?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

- ☐ Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country
1. Locate Lake Mead
 2. Lake Mead forms a border between which two states? (Nevada and Arizona)
 3. Follow the red line from Lake Mead. What is the next lake the Pages visit? (Great Salt Lake)
 4. Which state is the Great Salt Lake in? (Utah)
- ☐ Map Resource: United States Atlas "The West: Physical Map" p.128
1. Locate Great Salt Lake.
 2. Do you notice any differences between Lake Mead and the Great Salt Lake? (Great Salt Lake does not flow to the ocean.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.35-36 "It was hot" - "Really swim!"

→ MAP WORK

- ☐ Map Resource: My U.S. Map
1. Label Utah.
 2. Add and label the Great Salt Lake.

→ VIEW

50 Adventures in the 50 States
p.92-93 Look at the page spread and read about slot canyons.

• GEOGRAPHY WORK

If there is a lake near your home, go visit. Notice if it is man-made or natural. Is it there because of a dam? Can you see the dam? Does it look like a mound of dirt and grass, or is it concrete like the Hoover Dam.

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 52

Bodies of Water Pages Visited

☐ Materials: Cross-Country

→ DISCUSS

From reading in the last lesson, we will compare the Page family's visit to Lake Mead, the Great Salt Lake, and their visit to Catalina Island at the beginning of the book.

1. Which activities were similar in all 3? (e.g., swimming), and which ones were different? (No fishing in the Great Salt Lake)
2. What does the water in Great Salt Lake have in common with the water surrounding Catalina? (Saltwater)
3. How is the water different? (No fish versus fish)
4. Why might the Great Salt Lake be missing fish? (Salinity too high)
5. What is different between Lake Mead and the Great Salt Lake? (Lake Mead: blue, freshwater, fish. Great Salt Lake: green, saltwater, no fish).
6. Have you been to a freshwater lake or a saltwater lake?

→ DRAW

If you have been to a lake, draw a picture of your time there in your

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geography journal, making sure to note on the picture if it was freshwater or saltwater. If you have not been to a lake, choose either Lake Mead or Great Salt Lake, and draw what you would do there.

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 53

Continents

Materials: Cross-Country, Globe

→ INTRO

When doing our map work, sometimes we have used the word "continent." Do you remember what a continent is?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

1. Find California (and Los Angeles, if it is labeled).
2. "Zoom out" and locate the United States.
3. "Zoom out." What do you call the area including the United States, Canada, and Mexico? (North America)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-40 "Los Angeles" - "no one lives."

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 54

Continents, Continued

Materials: Globe

→ MAP QUESTIONS

(Questions taken from chapters on "Surface of the Earth" in Elementary Geography by Charlotte Mason)

1. Which continents are upon the Equator? (Africa and South America)
2. Which three continents are north of the Equator? (North America, Europe, Asia)
3. Which two lie south of the Equator? (Australia and Antarctica)
4. Which is the longest [pair of] continent(s) from north to south? (North and South America)
5. What continent lies east of Europe? (Asia)
6. What continent lies west of Europe? (North America)
7. What continent is to the south of Europe? (Africa)
8. Which continent(s) are quite surrounded by water? (Australia and Antarctica)

• Let's further explore what Ms. Mason was asking about continents.

1. Look on the globe, and locate where North America and South America are connected. (Panama/Colombia)
2. Where are Africa and Asia connected? (Egypt/Israel)
3. Which two continents do not have an obvious division and look like one large continent? (Europe and Asia)

WEEK 4 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 55

Rocky Mountains National Park

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas (5th edition map), My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Inside front cover map of Cross-Country

1. Take a minute to review "West" and "East" directions on a map. (Note: You may still have the sticky note with the compass rose on it from Lesson 11. If not, the student may look at their "My U.S. Map" for the compass rose.)
2. Locate Salt Lake City and Rocky Mountain National Park.
3. What direction do the Pages have to travel to reach the National Park? (east)

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

4. What is the dashed line that they cross? (border between Utah and Colorado)
5. Which is farther east—Utah or Colorado? (Colorado)
- 📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas "Colorado" p.137
- ∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF
1. Let's see where the Pages are. Locate Rocky Mountain National Park.
2. They have not made it to the Rocky Mountain National Park yet, so look for mountainous areas west of the park.
3. What animals are west of the Rocky Mountain National Park? (Sheep)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.42-43 "As they drove" - "We'll do ours."

→ MAP WORK

- 📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map
1. Add Rocky Mountain National Park to your map. If you want to mark the Park with a symbol, recall images of what Tom and Ruth saw and think of a unique symbol (like a snow-covered mountain or a mountain sheep).
 2. Label the Rocky Mountains so that the label slants across the map to mimic the range stretching across multiple states.

WEEK 4 📄 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 56

Canyons

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas

→ NOTE

We will be looking at the Grand Canyon over the next few lessons. The reason for this is that the Grand Canyon is a familiar, very large example of a canyon. Just to clarify, the Pages do not visit the Grand Canyon, but spend time in a smaller canyon in Colorado.

→ INTRO

What do you think will happen to the man? Will they find a doctor?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

- 📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas "Arizona" p.119
1. Look at the picture at the bottom of p.118. This is the Grand Canyon.
 2. Notice how steep the sides of the canyon are. Can you see from the picture that the canyon is very deep?
 3. Locate the Grand Canyon on p.119 in the northwestern portion of the state.
 4. From the map, are you able to see that the river is much lower than the land beside it?
 5. Look at other canyons nearby. Would you describe them as narrow or wide? (Narrow when compared to the Grand Canyon)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.44 "Two hours later" - "too steep for them after dark."

WEEK 5 📄 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 57

Canyons, Continued

📄 Materials: Cross-Country

→ DISCUSS

1. How easy is it for you to find a doctor if you need one?
2. Jim Field said that Doc Jones was the only doctor located within 40 miles; even so, the doctor was still hard to find sometimes. Why do you think that is? (Mountainous areas are isolated, and there are probably too few people to require more doctors.)



Term 3

3. Why does the doctor say that the path is too steep for Mrs. Page and Ruth after dark? Why would the path be easier for him? (Maybe because Doc Jones is accustomed to the terrain.)

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: linked maps

Spend time exploring this amazing Map of the Grand Canyon published by the National Park Service. You can compare it to larger Area Maps with the Grand Canyon (top map). See if you can find “Desert View” and “North Rim (Visitor Center)” on each map.

∞ Map Link: Map of the Grand Canyon

∞ Map Link: Area Maps with the Grand Canyon

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.44-45 “The doctor worked first” - “said the doctor.”

WEEK 5 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 58

Canyon Model

📄 Materials: 50 Adventures in the 50 States, Moon Sand (Kinetic Sand)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Take a look at the Arizona and Colorado pages (p.10-11 and p.16-17) to see more canyons.

→ MODEL

Look at this picture of a canyon to prepare for making your own model of one.

∞ Image Link: Picture of a Canyon

Based on pictures and your reading, make a model of a canyon with your sand.

WEEK 6 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 59

Rocky Mountains

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Today we will spend our time using maps.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. Locate the Great Salt Lake.

2. Name the city found along the red route near the lake.

3. The next stop on the Page’s route is Rocky Mountain National Park.

Follow the red line from the Great Salt Lake to Rocky Mountain National Park.

4. What do you notice, first to the north, and then to the south, of their route? (Mountains)

5. These mountains are a part of what large mountain range? (Rocky Mountains)

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “Colorado” p.137 (5th edition)

∞ PDF link: 5th edition map

1. Locate Rocky Mountain National Park. What color is this area on the map? (Yellow)

2. Using the map key on p.7 (United States Atlas), what does that yellow color represent? (Look through the list and see if National Park is an option. Everything represented by yellow falls under the National Park System.)

3. There is a large area of green on this map of Colorado, some of it surrounding the Rocky Mountain National Park. Using the map key again on p.7, what does this green represent? (National Forest)

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

4. Now, using the Economy Symbols map key on p.137, what are the most prevalent symbols inside the green area? (Mining and tourism) Discuss why those economies are found there.
5. Now, what animal-related economy symbols do you find in or just outside of the green area? (Ensure that you notice the sheep, which will show up in Cross-Country.)
6. Discuss why sheep are found there but not other livestock, like cows. (It is okay if you cannot think of a reason or if they do not know the difference in how sheep and cattle pasture. Nonetheless, the question does help them notice geographic differences in livestock distribution. General thoughts can be that cattle require larger areas for grazing than sheep; cattle eat grass, whereas sheep can consume a wide range of weeds; sheep can navigate hilly, steep terrain that cattle cannot.)

→ MAP WORK

My U.S. Map
Label Colorado

WEEK 6 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 60

RMNP and a Lake

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas

→ INTRO

Now we will learn a little more about the Rocky Mountain National Park.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "Colorado" p.136–137

1. Locate Rocky Mountain National Park.
 2. The Pages will come into Rocky Mountain National Park on the southwestern end. Can you find a body of water there? It is right on the edge of the park. (Lake Granby)
- ∞ Map Link: Brochure Map of RMNP (change the view from standard map to brochure map and zoom in on this map)
1. This is a map of the Rocky Mountain National Park.
 2. Locate Lake Granby on the southern end of the park.
 3. There are two smaller lakes north of Lake Granby; what are their names? (Grand Lake and Shadow Mountain Lake)
 4. Which of these lakes have dams? (Lake Granby and Shadow Mountain Lake) These are man-made.
 5. Which lake does not have a dam? (Grand Lake) This is a natural lake.
 6. When Cross-Country was written, only Grand Lake was there. The dams that created the other 2 lakes were made a few years later.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.46-47 "Just outside" - "would never forget."

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

We spent time earlier this year talking about different types of maps. You might enjoy this panoramic view of RMNP

∞ Map Link: Panoramic View of RMNP

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 61

Colorado River

Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Have you ever been to a National Park?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

∞ Map Link: Brochure Map of RMNP

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

1. Locate Lake Granby.
2. Locate Granby Dam. What river runs south out of the lake?
3. Now, instead of following the river south, let's back up to find the headwaters of the Colorado River.
4. Locate Shadow Mountain Lake.
5. Do you see the Colorado River to the west of Shadow Mountain Lake?
6. Can you follow it north as far as it goes? (If you follow it north, you will see it continue to the north past the Colorado River trailhead.)
7. You have found the head of the Colorado River! Now, can you trace it south through the park? (It is kind of hard to follow, so the parent may need to help. It flows into Shadow Mountain Lake, then out of the lake and into Lake Granby, and then out through Granby Dam.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-49 "Snow and ice" - "in the ocean."

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Label the Colorado River (if not already added to your map).

WEEK 7 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 62

Colorado River, Continued

📄 Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

I wonder where the water from our kitchen faucet comes from? I wonder how far it travels before it gets to us?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. Locate Rocky Mountain National Park.
2. Follow the Colorado River from Rocky Mountain National Park to Lake Mead.
3. Do you remember when the Pages visited Lake Mead to swim? Do you remember what the water was used for?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.50 "This is another" - "the Rocky Mountains."

WEEK 8 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 63

Mountain Weather

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, Student World Atlas

→ INTRO

What do you think the weather is like in the mountains? What do you think the temperature is like during the summer? Winter?

→ MAP QUESTION

Read: "Elevation" and "Landforms" Student World Atlas p.22

Based on what you read, what do you think the climate is like in the Rocky Mountains? (Cool)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.51 "Sometimes the clouds" - "clothes with them."

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 8 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 64

Mountain Plants and Animals

Materials: Cross-Country

→ DISCUSS

Based on what you learned during our last lesson about elevation and landforms:

1. What plants do you think you would find in the park?
2. What animals do you think you would find in the park?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-54 “Thick forests” - “are called plains.”

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 65

Denver

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

The Pages will be in Colorado for a little while longer.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Colorado” p.136–137

1. Locate Denver. (Hint: it is the state capital.)
2. If you did not provide the hint, state that Denver has a special city symbol. Do you know what it means?
3. Denver is the capital of which state?
4. Is Denver west or east of Rocky Mountain National Park? (East)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.55-56 “In Denver” - “don’t feel strange.”

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Do you remember where the family that bought the Pages’ house was from? You may have already added it to your map. (Denver) If not, add it.

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 66

Mountains on Maps

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, Globe, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

How would you draw the Rocky Mountains on your map?

→ MAP QUESTION

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Cross Section” p.8–9

1. Read and study the cross-section of the United States.
2. Pay attention to the difference in height of the coast in California (San Francisco) and the Rocky Mountains.
3. Discuss the difference between drawing a cross-section and what the same mountains look like on the large “Physical Map” on the same page.
4. Have you seen other ways to draw mountains on a map? (Possibly something like ^ ^)

Map Resource: Globe

1. Locate the United States.
2. Locate the Rocky Mountain Range.
3. See if you can find mountain ranges on all of the continents.

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.57-60 "In the picture" - "for most animals."

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. The Rocky Mountains should already be labeled on your map. Draw symbols under/around the label so that it represents mountains. Be careful not to draw over your label.
2. Add anything you have seen on your journey with the Pages that you would like to add.

WEEK 10 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 67

Scale

📄 Materials: pencil, paper, the Grid paper (1:3 ratio)

∞ Link: Grid paper (1:3 ratio)

→ MAP WORK

1. We will be using a grid to reduce a simple drawing.
2. Take the larger grid paper.
3. Draw a simple shape onto the large grid paper. (Draw a simple house, or any basic shape.)
4. Draw the reduced image onto the small grid based on the figure on the large grid.
5. Share your observations.

→ NOTE

In a few lessons, we will use this skill of scale drawing to draw a map of your neighborhood to scale. The next lesson requires the game Battleship or a printed version. See next week to print ahead of time.

WEEK 10 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 68

Scale, Continued

📄 Materials: Battleship game or a Picture of Battleship

∞ Image Link: Picture of Battleship

→ MAP WORK

(Battleship)

1. Observe a battleship game board or the Picture of Battleship.
 2. What similarities do you notice between the game board and a map? (grid lines on both)
 3. Play a game of Battleship. If you don't have the game, you can play this Printable Battleship version by printing out 2 copies (one for each person). You will need to cut out the "ships" in order to play.
- ∞ Link: Printable Battleship

→ NOTE

The game Battleship is similar to a scaled-down grid of a battle. In other words, the ships are scaled-down versions of an actual ship, therefore some ships are bigger than others. Next week, we will start a scale map of your neighborhood.

WEEK 11 📅 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 69

Pacing and Scale Map

📄 Materials: Making Your Own Maps, a large piece of paper (can be a large piece of art paper, legal-size paper, etc.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-9 "Say you want" - "Label it."

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ PRACTICE

Spend a couple of minutes practicing pacing. This means that you practice keeping the same length/pace of steps. Take 10 steps away from your home, and try to take 10 to get back to the same spot.

→ MAP DRAWING

Today, we will begin a new map of your home and your neighbors. Your map will only be as big as your piece of paper.

1. The book said that 25 steps are the same as an inch.
2. Pace the outside general area of your home, and draw it on one of the middle edges of your paper. (For example, if it takes 50 paces to walk across the front of your home, that line would be 2 inches long on the paper. If the width is 25 steps, that will be one inch. Please don't worry about being super precise; we just want to begin building the idea of scale.)
3. After you have drawn your home, begin to move outwards. (You will have another lesson to finish this, and you are free to work on it in the afternoons or during assessment week.)
4. First, you will need to do things like pace the space between your home and the nearest neighbor. Then, pace the outside of your neighbor's house. (Make sure to get permission.)
5. Work on it until your class time is up.

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 70

Scale Map, Continued

→ MAP DRAWING

Today, we continue your scale map of your home and your neighbors.

1. Don't forget that 25 steps equal an inch on your map.
2. Assess how far you went last lesson.
3. Continue to move outward from your home. Work on it for the class time, trying to add at least 2 neighbors.
4. Do you notice that scale mapping is much more time-consuming? I wonder how long geographers have to work on a map, and if there are things they learn to do it more quickly.
5. If you want to continue your map, feel free to use the afternoon time.

WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Cross-Country

WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.) - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Models and maps made during the term

Geography: Grade 2 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

- Cross-Country: Tell about the Pages' visit to Catalina Island. Describe what an island is.
- Redwoods: Tell what you remember about the biome of a Redwood Forest. What do you remember about redwoods and the things that live in or near them?

Term 2

- Cross-Country: Tell what you have learned about the effects of water (when it rains) OR tell what you know about the desert.
- Locate on a U.S. map: Los Angeles, CA; Mojave Desert; Lake Mead

Term 3

- Cross-Country: Tell about the episode in the canyon. Describe what a canyon is OR tell what you know about mountain water in the Rocky Mountain National Park.
- Locate on a US map: Los Angeles, CA; Rocky Mountain National Park